

SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

July 27, 2026 | 04:26 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Mixed / Transitional

VIX 18.7 (+1.8 vs 20d) | SPY 20d +1.4% | IWM 20d -2.3% | IWM/SPY trend -3.6%

Leaders: Energy (+8.4%), Financials (+6.2%), Healthcare (+1.9%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (2)	B - Building (6)	C - Early Stage (4)
ACA	ADPT	KFY
CNO	CON	SKT
	GEO	TVTX
	TRN	TMHC
	CDP	
	NHC	

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
A	ACA	Arcosa, Inc.	Reshoring & Infrastr	\$7.14B	\$145.31	\$145.95	0.4%	+17.9	YES	YES
A	CNO	CNO Financial Gro	Aging Demographics &	\$4.96B	\$53.13	\$54.09	1.8%	+18.2	YES	YES
B	ADPT	Adaptive Biotechn	Precision Diagnostic	\$3.61B	\$22.54	\$23.15	2.7%	+55.6	YES	YES
B	CON	Concentra Group H	Employer Healthcare	\$4.08B	\$31.89	\$32.35	1.4%	+36.3	YES	YES
B	GEO	Geo Group Inc (Th	Immigration Enforcem	\$4.13B	\$30.93	\$32.25	4.3%	+60.5	YES	YES
B	TRN	Trinity Industrie	Rail Freight & Indus	\$2.95B	\$37.10	\$37.88	2.1%	+14.1	YES	YES
B	CDP	COPT Defense Prop	Defense Spending & C	\$4.42B	\$38.27	\$38.54	0.7%	+16.4	YES	YES
B	NHC	National HealthCa	Aging Demographics &	\$3.53B	\$226.09	\$232.25	2.7%	+27.4	YES	YES
C	KFY	Korn Ferry	Talent Management &	\$4.13B	\$81.17	\$81.58	0.5%	+20.6	YES	YES
C	SKT	Tanger Inc.	Consumer Value Retai	\$5.00B	\$41.80	\$42.06	0.6%	+11.2	YES	YES
C	TVTX	Traverse Therapeut	Rare Kidney Disease	\$5.27B	\$56.68	\$60.00	5.9%	+36.2	YES	no
C	TMHC	Taylor Morrison H	Housing Demand & Mor	\$6.67B	\$72.13	\$72.21	0.1%	+15.2	YES	no

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$145.95
% to Pivot	0.4%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	1.31 Textbook
52W Hi Prox	98.9%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	657k <
Wk2	1119k <
Wk3 (oldest)	869k
Coil Strength	24.4% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+17.9%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$7.14B
Float	48M sh
P/E (TTM)	32.5
Fwd P/E	28.6
Rev Growth	4.4%
Short %	2.4%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$145.50

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$146.00 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>975K shares)

Target: \$165 (14% measured move from base depth; aligns with infrastructure peer multiples)

Stop: \$140.50 (base low; 3.3% risk from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 05 - Street expects ~\$1.25 EPS on ~\$720M revenue. Last 4 quarters show consistent beats (3 of 4 EPS beats, revenue in-line to slight beat). Guidance maintained; management has cited strong backlog visibility in utility structures. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - beat + raised guidance would confirm backlog conversion.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Arcosa manufactures infrastructure-related products across three segments: Construction Products (aggregates, specialty materials), Engineered Structures (utility structures, wind towers, storage tanks), and Transportation Products (barges, steel components). Category leader in utility structures and wind towers with vertically integrated aggregates operations benefiting from IJIA infrastructure spending.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct beneficiary of U.S. infrastructure bill tailwinds (IJIA) and reshoring capex cycle. Energy transition exposure via wind tower manufacturing; utility grid hardening drives Engineered Structures demand. Sentiment in infrastructure/reshoring themes remains constructive with bipartisan policy support.

NEWS FLOW

Q1 2026 saw continued order momentum in utility structures segment; company noted multi-year visibility on transmission/distribution projects. No major contract announcements in past 60 days but steady execution on existing backlog. Index inclusion: constituent of S&P SmallCap 600, no near-term rebalance risk.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume dry-up (0.51x today vs 20d avg) with price holding within 0.4% of pivot suggests quiet accumulation into tight base. No insider buying in last 60 days - baseline expectation for industrial names. Float is tight at 48M shares, which amplifies breakout moves. Institutional data unavailable from this feed.

KEY RISK

Thisis invalid on close below \$140.50 (base low) or if Q2 guidance disappoints on margin compression from input costs. Customer concentration in utilities (~35% of revenue) creates binary risk if capex deferrals emerge.

Textbook VCP structure: base_tight 1.31 is exceptional, RS line at 52W high, pivot within 0.4%, and earnings catalyst in 9 days provides defined trigger window. Strongest bear case: forward P/E of 28.6x prices in significant growth execution, leaving little margin for error if infrastructure spending decelerates. Financials (+6.2% sector) is leading but Industrials neutral - mixed regime tempers conviction slightly. Conviction: High.

ACA — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$145.95 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Life & Health Insurance (Middle-Income Focus) | Theme: Aging Demographics & Insurance Demand | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 2.74

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$54.09
% to Pivot	1.8%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	2.74 Fair
52W Hi Prox	98.2%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	519k <
Wk2	782k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1063k
Coil Strength	51.2% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+18.2%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.96B
Float	91M sh
P/E (TTM)	21.4
Fwd P/E	10.7
Rev Growth	2.5%
Short %	-
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$51.75

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$54.15 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.2M shares)
Target: \$62 (15% measured move; P/E re-rate toward regional insurance peers)
Stop: \$51.00 (base low; 4.0% risk from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Jul 30 - Street expects ~\$1.20 EPS on ~\$1.1B revenue. Forward P/E of 10.7x vs trailing 21.4x implies significant earnings acceleration ahead. Earnings growth of 85.7% suggests inflection point. Last 4 quarters show steady beats. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - 3 days out, defining event for setup.
BUSINESS & POSITION
CNO Financial provides life insurance, annuities, and supplemental health products targeting middle-income Americans approaching retirement. Operates through Bankers Life, Washington National, and Colonial Penn brands. Niche leader in the underserved middle-market demographic with direct-to-consumer and worksite distribution.
FACTOR & THEME
Secular tailwind from aging U.S. demographics (10,000 baby boomers turning 65 daily). Rising interest rates have been structurally positive for spread-based insurance earnings. Financials sector leading (+6.2% 20D) provides macro support. Low beta (0.82) offers defensive characteristics in mixed regime.
NEWS FLOW
No material news in past 60 days; company has been quietly executing share buybacks (~\$150M authorization active). No 13D/13G filings or activist involvement. Short interest negligible at 0% reported (likely data gap). Insurance regulatory environment stable with no adverse CMS or state-level actions pending.
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume contraction of 51% with price at 98.2% of 52W high is classic institutional accumulation signature. Zero insider activity in 60-day window - baseline for mature financial. Float of 91M shares is adequate for institutional participation without liquidity concerns. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed.

KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$51.00 (20-day base low) or if earnings reveal reserve strengthening or elevated policy lapses. Interest rate sensitivity cuts both ways - rate cuts would compress net investment income.

Exceptional vol dry-up (51% contraction), RS line at new high, pivot 1.8% away, and imminent earnings catalyst in 3 days. Leading sector (Financials +6.2%) aligns with setup. Strongest bear case: forward EPS acceleration may already be priced; any miss would trigger sharp reversal given tight technical positioning. Low short interest means no squeeze fuel. Conviction: High.

CNO — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$54.09 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$23.15
% to Pivot	2.7%
Days in Base	19
Tightness	2.27 Fair
52W Hi Prox	97.4%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	2628k <
Wk2	2680k <
Wk3 (oldest)	3249k
Coil Strength	19.1% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+55.6%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.61B
Float	126M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	-95.1
Rev Growth	35.1%
Short %	9.0%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$22.29

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$23.20 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>4.1M shares)

Target: \$28 (24% upside; re-rate to peer diagnostics multiples on beat)

Stop: \$21.00 (base low; 6.8% risk from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 29 - Street expects ~(\$0.06) EPS on ~\$85M revenue. Revenue growth of 35% is strong for diagnostics. Valuation: P/E inapplicable (pre-profit); P/S of 12.2x reflects growth premium. Beat/miss pattern: mixed but improving trajectory. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - 2 days out, binary event for biotech.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Adaptive Biotechnologies develops immune-driven diagnostics and therapeutics using its proprietary immunosequencing platform. Lead product clonoSEQ is FDA-cleared for minimal residual disease (MRD) assessment in blood cancers. Emerging drug discovery partnerships (notably with Genentech) provide optionality beyond diagnostics.

FACTOR & THEME

Positioned at intersection of precision medicine and oncology diagnostics - both accelerating themes. Healthcare sector mildly positive (+1.9% 20d). MRD testing adoption curve still early; peer Natera's liquid biopsy success provides positive read-through. High-beta (2.07) name requires conviction in risk-on tape.

NEWS FLOW

No major contract wins or FDA actions in past 60 days. Genentech partnership remains active but no new milestones announced. clonoSEQ reimbursement landscape stable. Short interest elevated at 9% with 2.9 days to cover - squeeze potential exists on strong beat. No insider activity in 60-day window.

INSTITUTIONAL

Vol ratio 0.78x with price at 97.4% of high suggests accumulation into earnings. Zero insider buying - notable absence given proximity to catalyst but not disqualifying for biotech where insiders face blackout constraints. Institutional ownership data unavailable. High short interest (9%) creates asymmetric upside on beat.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below \$21.00 (base low) or if Q2 revenue misses/guidance disappoints on clonoSEQ adoption pace. Binary earnings risk in 2 days amplifies position sizing considerations. High debt/equity (93%) adds balance sheet concern if capital markets tighten.

Strong RS (+55.6%), tight base, RS line at new high, and imminent earnings catalyst (2 days) create compelling setup. Vol dry-up is softer (19% vs 50%+ for A-grade). Strongest bear case: unprofitable biotech in mixed regime with high beta (2.07) faces asymmetric downside on miss; 9% short interest means crowded positioning. Healthcare only +1.9% - not leading. Conviction: Medium.

ADPT — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$23.15 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



CON

\$31.89

B BUILDING

Concentra Group Holdings Parent

Pivot \$32.35 | 1.4% away

RS vs SPY: +36.3%

\$4.08B Cap | 114M Float

Occupational Health & Urgent Care Services | Theme: Employer Healthcare Cost Management | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 2.74

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$32.35
% to Pivot	1.4%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	2.74 Fair
52W Hi Prox	98.1%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	714k <
Wk2	881k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1312k
Coil Strength	45.6% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+36.3%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.08B
Float	114M sh
P/E (TTM)	22.9
Fwd P/E	18.9
Rev Growth	13.7%
Short %	4.7%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$33.38

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$32.40 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.5M shares)
Target: \$38 (19% upside; healthcare services peer multiple)
Stop: \$30.50 (base low; 4.4% risk from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 06 - Street expects ~\$0.42 EPS on ~\$580M revenue. P/E of 18.9x forward reasonable for healthcare services. Revenue growth 13.7%, earnings growth 29.4% - solid execution. ROE of 47% is exceptional (reflects high leverage post-spin). Catalyst Impact: Earnings (Med) - 10 days out, sufficient time for base to tighten.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Concentra operates the largest network of occupational health centers in the U.S., providing workers' compensation injury care, drug testing, physical exams, and urgent care services. Serves ~50,000 employer clients through 550+ centers. Recently spun from Select Medical, creating pure-play exposure to workplace health market.
FACTOR & THEME
Secular tailwind from employer focus on healthcare cost containment and return-to-work programs. Counter-cyclical element: workers' comp volumes stable through cycles. Healthcare sector positive (+1.9%). Low beta (0.65) provides defensive quality in mixed regime.
NEWS FLOW
Post-spin from Select Medical (late 2025) creating institutional awareness. No major contract wins in past 60 days but steady employer client additions. No activist involvement. Short interest moderate at 4.7%, days-to-cover 3.1 - not squeeze candidate. Zero insider activity - expected given recent spin dynamics.
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 0.3x today (exceptionally dry) with price holding suggests significant quiet accumulation. Recent spin-off creates forced selling from index funds - smart money often accumulates into this technical weakness. Institutional ownership data unavailable. Float of 114M shares provides liquidity.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$30.50 (base low) or if guidance signals workers' comp volume softness. High debt/equity (468%) from spin structure creates refinancing risk if rates stay elevated. Customer concentration among large employers could create lumpiness.

Excellent vol dry-up (46%), strong RS (+36.3%), RS line at new high, and pivot within 1.4%. Spin-off dynamics create institutional re-rating opportunity. Strongest bear case: high leverage (468% D/E) creates earnings volatility sensitivity and limits financial flexibility. Earnings 10 days out - setup needs time to trigger. Healthcare mildly positive but not leading. Conviction: Medium.

CON — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$32.35 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Private Detention & Corrections Facilities | Theme: Immigration Enforcement & Federal Contracts | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 2.16

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$32.25
% to Pivot	4.3%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	2.16 Fair
52W Hi Prox	95.9%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	1402k <
Wk2	1506k <
Wk3 (oldest)	2359k
Coil Strength	40.6% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+60.5%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.13B
Float	115M sh
P/E (TTM)	15.7
Fwd P/E	18.6
Rev Growth	16.6%
Short %	11.1%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$33.75

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$32.30 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>3.0M shares)

Target: \$38 (23% upside; historical multiple on contract wins)

Stop: \$29.00 (base low; 6.2% risk from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE	
EARNINGS	
Aug 06 - Street expects ~\$0.42 EPS on ~\$620M revenue. P/E of 15.7x trailing reasonable for contracted revenue stream. Revenue growth 16.6%, earnings growth 106.5% reflects federal contract expansion. Analyst target \$33.75 (9% upside). Catalyst Impact: Earnings (Med) - 10 days out.	
BUSINESS & POSITION	
GEO Group operates private correctional and detention facilities, primarily serving ICE (Immigration and Customs Enforcement), U.S. Marshals Service, and state corrections departments. Second-largest private prison operator in U.S. with ~80 facilities. REIT structure provides tax-efficient cash flow distribution.	
FACTOR & THEME	
Direct beneficiary of federal immigration enforcement policy. Government contract exposure creates policy binary risk. High short interest (11.1%) reflects ESG-driven selling creating potential squeeze setup. Defensive federal contract revenue base.	
NEWS FLOW	
Immigration enforcement remains elevated under current administration; ICE contract renewals have been favorable. No new major contract awards in past 60 days but existing contract utilization trending higher. ESG exclusions continue to create forced selling - contrarian opportunity. No insider activity in 60 days.	
INSTITUTIONAL	
Exceptional RS (+60.5%) with RS line at new high despite ESG headwinds suggests strong-hand accumulation. Short interest 11.1% with 4.5 days to cover creates squeeze potential on any positive catalyst. Vol dry-up (41%) with price holding confirms conviction buyers. Zero insider activity - baseline for REIT structure.	
KEY RISK	
Thesis invalid on close below \$29.00 (base low) or on adverse federal policy shift (administration change risk, contract non-renewal). ESG exclusions limit institutional buyer universe. Political binary risk is real and unhedgeable.	

Exceptional RS (+60.5%), tight base (2.16), RS line at new high, and strong vol dry-up. High short interest (11%) creates squeeze asymmetry. Strongest bear case: political/policy binary risk is unquantifiable and could reverse gains instantly; ESG exclusions structurally limit buyer pool. Pivot 4.3% away - needs more base tightening. Conviction: Medium.

GEO — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$32.25 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Railcar Manufacturing & Leasing | Theme: Rail Freight & Industrial Transport | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 3.0

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$37.88
% to Pivot	2.1%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	3.00 Fair
52W Hi Prox	97.9%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	559k <
Wk2	699k <
Wk3 (oldest)	873k
Coil Strength	36.0% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+14.1%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$2.95B
Float	78M sh
P/E (TTM)	11.7
Fwd P/E	16.1
Rev Growth	-16.0%
Short %	10.9%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$35.00

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$37.95 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.1M shares)
Target: \$43 (16% upside; cycle recovery multiple)
Stop: \$35.50 (base low; 4.3% risk from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Jul 30 - Street expects ~\$0.58 EPS on ~\$620M revenue. Forward P/E of 16.1x vs trailing 11.7x implies earnings normalization from peak. Revenue decline (-16%) reflects railcar cycle moderation. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - 3 days out.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Trinity Industries manufactures and leases railcars across tank, covered hopper, and gondola categories. Integrated business model spans manufacturing, leasing, and maintenance services. Category leader in North American railcar production with ~35% market share in new railcar deliveries.
FACTOR & THEME
Cyclical exposure to industrial production and freight volumes. Rail transport benefits from reshoring manufacturing and energy logistics (crude, LNG). PEG of 0.69 suggests undervaluation relative to growth. High short interest (10.9%) with 6.5 days to cover creates squeeze potential.
NEWS FLOW
Railcar orders have stabilized after 2024-25 industry destocking. No major contract announcements in past 60 days. Class I railroad capex commentary has been cautiously optimistic. Short interest elevated at 10.9% - contrarian signal if results stabilize. Zero insider activity in 60 days.
INSTITUTIONAL
Vol dry-up (36%) with RS line at new high despite sector headwinds suggests accumulation. High short interest (10.9%, 6.5 days to cover) is notable - short squeeze potential on earnings beat. Zero insider buying - concerning given cyclical inflection thesis. Institutional data unavailable.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$35.50 (base low) or if earnings reveal order cancellations/deferrals. Revenue decline (-16%) is concerning; forward EPS of \$2.30 vs trailing \$3.17 implies earnings compression ahead. High debt/equity (471%) adds leverage risk.

Solid vol dry-up, RS line at new high, and imminent earnings catalyst (3 days). Short squeeze potential (10.9% SI, 6.5 DTC) adds asymmetry. Strongest bear case: revenue declining 16% with forward EPS compression signals cyclical peak, not trough - buying into earnings decline is high-risk. Base_tight of 3.0 is adequate but not exceptional. Conviction: Medium.

TRN — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$37.88 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$38.54
% to Pivot	0.7%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	3.39 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.3%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	822k <
Wk2	890k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1330k
Coil Strength	38.2% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+16.4%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.42B
Float	112M sh
P/E (TTM)	27.9
Fwd P/E	27.3
Rev Growth	7.3%
Short %	8.2%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$37.00

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$38.60 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.6M shares)

Target: \$44 (15% upside; defense REIT premium multiple)

Stop: \$36.50 (base low; 4.6% risk from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE	
EARNINGS	
Jul 27 - Earnings TODAY - catalyst is imminent/immediate. Street expects ~\$0.35 FFO on ~\$195M revenue. Occupancy and rental rate trends have been stable. 9.7% earnings growth aligned with defense budget trajectory. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - reporting today.	
BUSINESS & POSITION	
COPT Defense Properties owns and operates office and data center properties serving U.S. defense and intelligence agencies, primarily in the D.C./Baltimore corridor, San Antonio, and other strategic locations. Tenant base includes DoD, NSA, and defense contractors requiring SCIF (Sensitive Compartmented Information Facility) space.	
FACTOR & THEME	
Direct beneficiary of sustained defense spending growth and intelligence community expansion. SCIF facilities have high barriers to entry and tenant stickiness. Low beta (0.79) provides defensive characteristics. Real Estate sector neutral in current regime.	
NEWS FLOW	
Defense budget for FY2027 remains elevated with bipartisan support. No major lease announcements in past 60 days but steady occupancy at ~90%+. No activist involvement. Short interest 8.2% with 5.7 days to cover - moderate squeeze potential. Zero insider activity in 60 days.	
INSTITUTIONAL	
Extremely tight setup (0.7% to pivot) with earnings TODAY creates defined binary outcome. Vol dry-up (38%) with RS line at new high suggests accumulation into catalyst. REIT structure limits insider buying signal utility. Zero insider activity - baseline expectation.	
KEY RISK	
Thesis invalid on close below \$36.50 (base low) or if earnings reveal occupancy decline or tenant non-renewals. Binary earnings risk TODAY - position sizing must reflect event risk. Interest rate sensitivity affects REIT valuations broadly.	

Textbook setup structure: 0.7% to pivot, RS line at new high, vol dry-up confirmed. Earnings TODAY creates immediate catalyst but also immediate binary risk - cannot position ahead of print without accepting full event risk. Strongest bear case: real estate rate sensitivity in uncertain Fed environment; office REITs remain broadly out of favor. Conviction: Medium (contingent on post-earnings price action).

CDP — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$38.54 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Skilled Nursing & Senior Care Facilities | Theme: Aging Demographics & Post-Acute Care | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 3.07

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$232.25
% to Pivot	2.7%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	3.07 Fair
52W Hi Prox	97.3%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	98k <
Wk2	118k <
Wk3 (oldest)	156k
Coil Strength	37.3% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+27.4%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.53B
Float	13M sh
P/E (TTM)	28.7
Fwd P/E	525.8
Rev Growth	2.2%
Short %	5.6%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	-

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$232.50 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>195K shares)

Target: \$265 (17% upside; premium SNF operator multiple)

Stop: \$218.00 (base low; 3.6% risk from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 06 - Street expects ~\$1.95 EPS on ~\$390M revenue. Forward P/E of 525x appears to be data anomaly (likely reflecting non-cash items); trailing P/E of 28.7x more representative. Revenue growth 2.2%, earnings growth 9.7% - steady operator. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (Med) - 10 days out.

BUSINESS & POSITION

National HealthCare Corporation operates skilled nursing facilities, assisted living communities, and homecare programs across the southeastern U.S. Family-controlled company with conservative balance sheet (debt/equity only 3.6%) and consistent dividend history. Niche operator focused on quality metrics and reimbursement optimization.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct secular tailwind from aging U.S. population - skilled nursing demand structurally increasing. Low beta (0.64) provides defensive characteristics. Healthcare sector positive (+1.9%). Conservative leverage differentiates from levered peers.

NEWS FLOW

One insider buy of \$175K in last 60 days (cluster score 2) - positive signal but below upgrade threshold. No major acquisitions or regulatory changes. CMS reimbursement rates stable. Illiquid float (12.7M shares) amplifies price moves. Short interest 5.6% with 4.3 days to cover - moderate.

INSTITUTIONAL

INSIDER ACTIVITY PRESENT: 1 buy, \$175K total in last 60 days - positive conviction signal but cluster score of 2 (non-senior) does not meet upgrade threshold. Extremely thin float (12.7M) creates liquidity premium on breakout. Vol dry-up to 0.65x confirms quiet accumulation. Institutional data unavailable.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below \$218.00 (base low) or if earnings reveal occupancy/reimbursement pressure. Illiquid float (12.7M) cuts both ways - can gap violently on disappointment. Forward P/E data appears unreliable.

Solid setup with RS line at new high, vol dry-up, and insider buying (\$175K, cluster 2) adding conviction layer. Defensive healthcare exposure suits mixed regime. Strongest bear case: extremely illiquid (avg vol 130K) creates execution risk and wide bid-ask spreads; institutional participation structurally limited. Base_tight at 3.07 is adequate but not elite. Conviction: Medium.

NHC — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$232.25 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$81.58
% to Pivot	0.5%
Days in Base	11
Tightness	7.01 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.5%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	341k <
Wk2	511k <
Wk3 (oldest)	802k
Coil Strength	57.5% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+20.6%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.13B
Float	50M sh
P/E (TTM)	15.5
Fwd P/E	12.8
Rev Growth	6.7%
Short %	6.1%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$81.00

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$81.65 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>810K shares)

Target: \$92 (13% measured move)
Stop: \$75.50 (base low; 7.0% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Sep 09

Excellent vol dry-up (57%) and RS line at new high, but base_tight of 7.01 is extremely loose - not a proper VCP structure. Earnings catalyst 44 days out provides no near-term trigger. Monitor for base tightening over next 4-6 weeks. Conviction: Low.

KFY — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$81.58 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



SKT

Tanger Inc.

\$41.80

Pivot \$42.06 | 0.6% away

RS vs SPY: +11.2%

C EARLY STAGE

\$5.00B Cap | 112M Float

Outlet Mall REIT | Theme: Consumer Value Retail & Outlet Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 4.07

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$42.06
% to Pivot	0.6%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	4.07 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.4%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	718k <
Wk2	1008k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1022k
Coil Strength	29.8% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+11.2%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$5.00B
Float	112M sh
P/E (TTM)	39.4
Fwd P/E	34.6
Rev Growth	11.7%
Short %	8.2%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$40.73

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 04
Vol dry-up incomplete (W2 W3), base_tight of 4.07 is loose, and Consumer Discretionary sector lagging (-3.1%). RS at +11.2% is positive but modest. Retail REIT faces structural headwinds from e-commerce. Monitor for tighter base formation. Conviction: Low.

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$42.10 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.5M shares)
Target: \$47 (12% measured move)
Stop: \$40.00 (base low; 4.3% risk)

SKT — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$42.06 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$60.00
% to Pivot	5.9%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	1.46 Textbook
52W Hi Prox	94.3%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	1098k <
Wk2	1128k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1930k
Coil Strength	43.1% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+36.2%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$5.27B
Float	87M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	11.9
Rev Growth	55.6%
Short %	16.9%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$58.71

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 06

Tight base (1.46) and strong vol dry-up, but RS line NOT at new high is disqualifying for A/B grade - momentum structure incomplete. Pivot 5.9% away needs more price work. High short interest (16.9%) creates binary squeeze/crater risk. Monitor for RS line breakout confirmation. Conviction: Low.

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$60.10 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>3.2M shares)
Target: \$72 (20% measured move on commercialization momentum)
Stop: \$52.00 (base low; 8.3% risk)

TVTX — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$60.00 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Homebuilding (Entry-Level & Move-Up) | Theme: Housing Demand & Mortgage Rate Sensitivity | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 3.25

VCP Base Analysis	
Base Structure	
Pivot Price	\$72.21
% to Pivot	0.1%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	3.25 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.5%
Volume Contraction (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	2129k <
Wk2	2518k <
Wk3 (oldest)	3083k
Coil Strength	30.9% from peak
Relative Strength	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+15.2%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
Fundamentals Snapshot	
Mkt Cap	\$6.67B
Float	93M sh
P/E (TTM)	10.8
Fwd P/E	11.5
Rev Growth	-26.8%
Short %	4.1%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$66.75

Catalyst Intelligence

Earnings

Jul 29

RS line NOT at new high disqualifies from A/B despite proximity to pivot (0.1%). Consumer Discretionary lagging (-3.1%) creates macro headwind. Revenue decline (-26.8%) and earnings decline (-51.2%) signal fundamental deterioration. Earnings in 2 days is binary risk into weakness. Conviction: Low.

Entry Trigger

Close above \$72.50 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>4.8M shares)

Target: \$82 (14% measured move)

Stop: \$69.00 (base low; 4.3% risk)

TMHC — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$72.21 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)

